Sample solution

Presenting research on e-mail practices in small businesses

Organisation: EDPM research group – Castries small businesses study
Portfolio element: Presentation using Presentation Software
Scenario: ppt-1

Model answer · Teacher's Version

How this meets the marking criteria

Criterion	Marks	Where it is met in this solution
Appropriate, attractive design suited to the topic (Ion theme or similar applied consistently to all 10 slides)	1	Ion-style design on all 10 slides from one slide master and four layouts: dark teal background, light-yellow headings and white text; the same icon-in-a-circle motif, colours and positions throughout (slides on pp. 6–15; overview on pp. 2–5).
Clear spaces on slides (no more than six bullets, uncluttered); recommended font size (headings 40 pt, body text 24 pt or larger) and style (Calibri (one sans-serif font family)); background colour that contrasts with the text – all required	3	Every heading 40 pt bold; body text 28 pt, and 24 pt beside the charts and on the References slide (never below 24 pt); Calibri only, including charts; at most 5 bullets per slide with wide margins and free space around icons and charts; strong contrast: white and light-yellow text on dark teal.
Appropriate use of animation: Fly In (from left) entrance on bullets (slides 2, 3, 5 and 9) and Wipe on charts, consistent and not distracting	2	Fly In (From Left) entrance, On Click, one bullet at a time (By Paragraph) on slides 2, 3, 5 and 9; Wipe (From Bottom) entrance, On Click, on each chart (slides 6, 7 and 8). No other effects. Saved in the .pptx (Animation Pane); animations cannot show on paper.
Appropriate use of graphics (relevant images or icons and the charts on slides 6, 7 and 8) and transitions (Fade applied to all slides)	2	Relevant icons on slides 1–5 and 9; native column, bar and pie charts made with the chart tool, each with a title and percentage data labels, on slides 6, 7 and 8 (pp. 11, 12 and 13); sources credited on the References slide. Fade transition, Duration 01.00, On Mouse Click, on all 10 slides.
Headings on each slide and appropriate sequencing: title, introduction, body (questions, method, findings) and conclusion/references	1	A heading on every slide, in a logical order: title (1), introduction (2), research questions (3), purpose (4), method (5), findings (6–8), recommendations and conclusion (9), references (10).
Speaker notes for each of the 10 slides, in full sentences that expand the slide content	2	Notes typed for all 10 slides (53–71 words each) in full sentences that expand the slide; printed as Notes Pages (pp. 6–15). Handouts, 3 slides per page (pp. 2–5). Every printed page carries the label Presentation using Presentation Software and the candidate's name.
Total	11	Every criterion is met in full.

Files in this pack: ppt-1 - Sample solution.pdf; Email Research Presentation.pptx.

Slide numbers and a footer with the candidate's name are on every slide except the title slide. Transitions and animations are saved in the .pptx and play in Slide Show. The icons are copyright-free (Font Awesome Free, CC BY 4.0) and are credited on the References slide. Pages 2–5: handouts (3 slides per page); pages 6–15: Notes Pages.

E-mail Use in Small Businesses in Castries

EDPM Research Presentation

[Candidate Name]

Seagrape Bay Secondary School

November 2026



Introduction

- E-mail: the main business medium
- Fast, cheap, many recipients at once
- Features: To, Cc, Bcc, attachments, subject line
- Problem: errors in dispatch



[Candidate Name] 2

Research Questions

- Which e-mail features are used regularly?
- How often do dispatch errors occur?
- How do businesses confirm receipt?



[Candidate Name] 3

Purpose of the Research

- To identify good and poor e-mail practices
- To suggest ways to reduce errors
- To help businesses communicate efficiently

[Candidate Name] 4

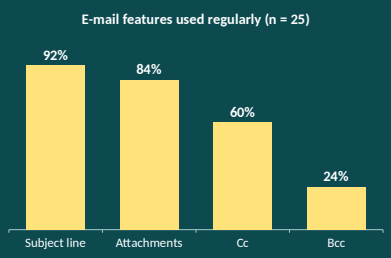
Method of Investigation

- Quantitative survey
- Questionnaire of 12 items
- Purposive sample: 25 employees, 25 businesses
- Permission from each manager
- Data collected 5–16 October 2026

[Candidate Name] 5

Features Used Regularly

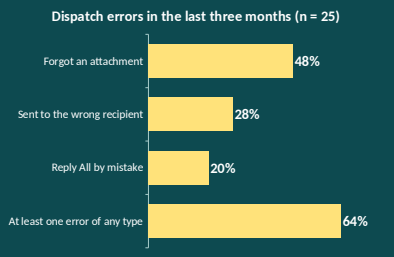
- Subject line used by 92%
- Bcc used by only 24%



[Candidate Name] 6

Errors in Dispatch

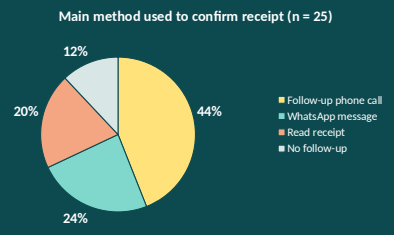
- 64% had at least one error in three months
- Forgotten attachment most common (48%)



[Candidate Name] 7

Confirming Receipt

- Phone call most common (44%)
- 12% do not follow up at all



[Candidate Name] 8

Recommendations and Conclusion

- Short staff training on Cc and Bcc
- Use a check-before-send routine
- Turn on attachment reminders
- E-mail is valuable but errors are common



[Candidate Name] 9

References

Caribbean Examinations Council. (2024). *CSEC® electronic document preparation and management syllabus* (CXC 34/G/SYLL 24).

GCFGlobal. (n.d.). *Email basics*. https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/email101/

Jacob, A. M., & Augustine, A. (2012). *Electronic document preparation and management for CSEC* (2nd ed.). Oxford University Press.

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[Candidate Name] 10



Good morning, managers, teachers and classmates. I am a Form 5 EDPM candidate, and I am presenting the findings of my group's research into how employees of small businesses in Castries use e-mail. E-mail is now the main way these businesses deal with suppliers, cruise-ship agents and customers, so a careless message can cost them time, money and goodwill.

Introduction

- E-mail: the main business medium
- Fast, cheap, many recipients at once
- Features: To, Cc, Bcc, attachments, subject line
- Problem: errors in dispatch



[Candidate Name] 2

E-mail has become the main business medium because it is fast, cheap and can reach many recipients at once. It also offers useful features such as To, Cc and Bcc, attachments and a subject line. However, the owners we spoke to reported a real problem: errors in dispatch, such as messages sent to the wrong person or sent without the promised attachment.

Research Questions

- Which e-mail features are used regularly?
- How often do dispatch errors occur?
- How do businesses confirm receipt?



[Candidate Name] 3

Our study set out to answer three questions. The first asks which e-mail features employees use regularly, which links to the syllabus objective on the features of e-mail. The second asks how often dispatch errors occur, and the third asks how businesses confirm that a message was received. These two questions link to the disadvantages of e-mail that we studied in Section VII.

Purpose of the Research

- To identify good and poor e-mail practices
- To suggest ways to reduce errors
- To help businesses communicate efficiently



[Candidate Name] 4

We carried out this study to identify good and poor e-mail practices in real Castries businesses and to suggest practical ways of reducing errors. The managers who took part will benefit directly, because the results show where their staff need support. Customers also benefit, because fewer errors mean faster and more reliable service.

Method of Investigation

- Quantitative survey
- Questionnaire of 12 items
- Purposive sample: 25 employees, 25 businesses
- Permission from each manager
- Data collected 5–16 October 2026

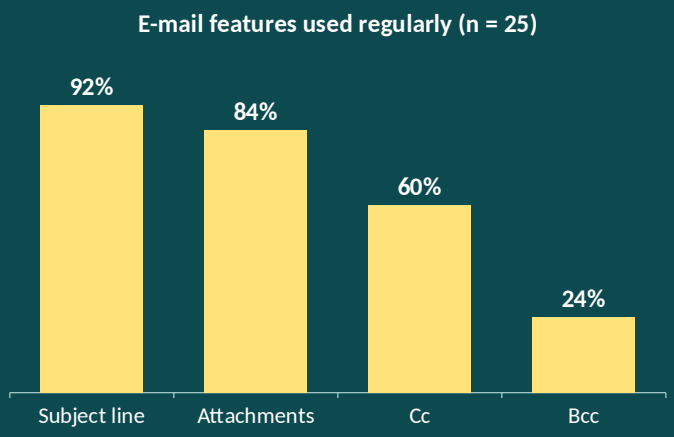


[Candidate Name] 5

We chose a quantitative survey because it produces numbers that can be totalled, compared and charted. We used purposive sampling, choosing one employee who uses e-mail every day from each of 25 businesses on Bridge Street and William Peter Boulevard. Each manager gave written permission first. We delivered the twelve-item questionnaire by hand between 5 and 16 October 2026 and collected it two days later.

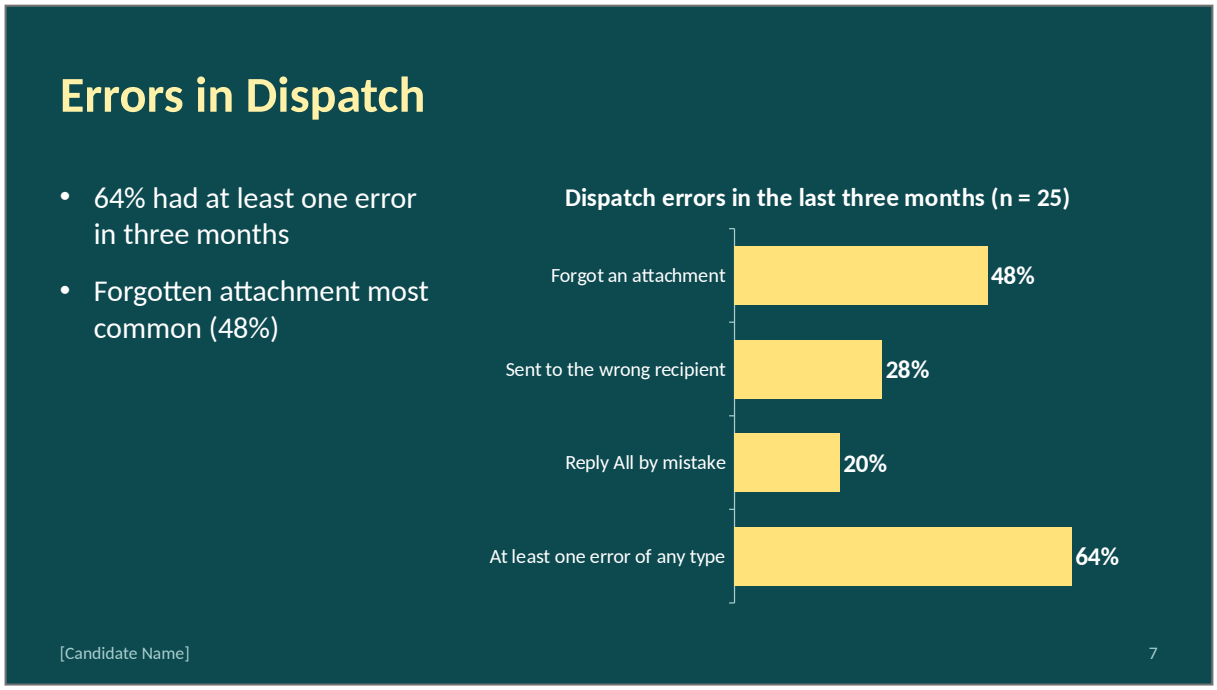
Features Used Regularly

- Subject line used by 92%
- Bcc used by only 24%

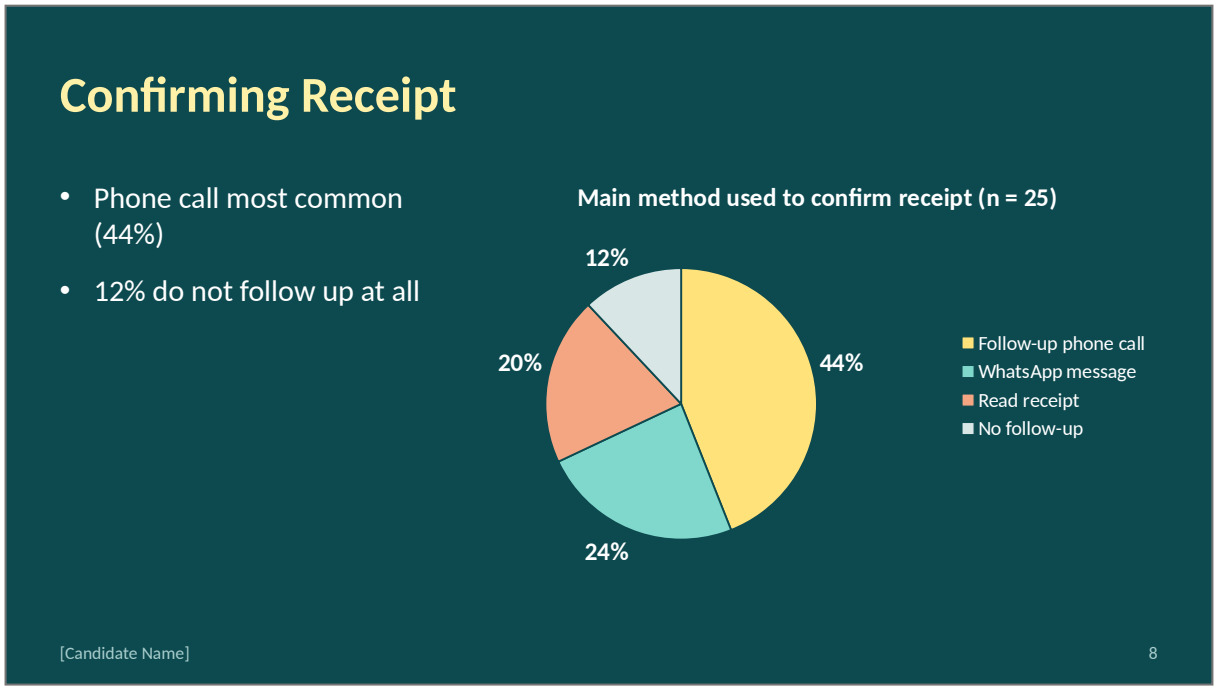


[Candidate Name] 6

This column chart shows the e-mail features used regularly. Respondents could tick more than one feature. Twenty-three of the 25 employees use a subject line and 21 send attachments, but only six use Bcc. This matters because Bcc hides customers' addresses from one another, so most businesses are not protecting their customers' privacy when they send group messages.



This bar chart shows the dispatch errors reported for the last three months. Sixteen of the 25 employees, or 64 per cent, made at least one error. A forgotten attachment was the most common mistake, reported by twelve employees. Each error means a second e-mail and a delay for the customer and, when a message reaches the wrong person, a possible breach of confidentiality.



Each employee gave one answer here, so the data can be shown as a pie chart. Most businesses rely on a second medium: 44 per cent make a follow-up phone call and 24 per cent send a WhatsApp message. Only 20 per cent use read receipts, and three businesses do not follow up at all. This reflects a known disadvantage of e-mail: the sender cannot be sure the message was received.

Recommendations and Conclusion

- Short staff training on Cc and Bcc
- Use a check-before-send routine
- Turn on attachment reminders
- E-mail is valuable but errors are common



[Candidate Name] 9

We make two recommendations. First, each business should give staff a short training session on when to use Cc and Bcc. Second, staff should follow a check-before-send routine and switch on the attachment reminder in their e-mail program. Managers could introduce both at one staff meeting next month. In conclusion, e-mail is valuable to Castries businesses, but dispatch errors are common and can be reduced.

References

Caribbean Examinations Council. (2024). *CSEC® electronic document preparation and management syllabus* (CXC 34/G/SYLL 24).

GCFGlobal. (n.d.). *Email basics*. https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/email101/

Jacob, A. M., & Augustine, A. (2012). *Electronic document preparation and management for CSEC* (2nd ed.). Oxford University Press.

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[Candidate Name] 10

Thank you for listening. Our background information came from the CSEC EDPM syllabus, the Jacob and Augustine textbook and the GCFGlobal e-mail tutorials, and the icons are free to use under the licence shown. I would especially like to thank the 25 managers and employees who took part. I am happy to answer any questions you may have.